
Nishant Dougall

They/Them

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To the TGD Peer Navigator Coordinator at Transgender Victoria,

RE: TGD Peer Navigator Opportunity

I am excited to submit my application for the position of TGD Peer Navigator at Transgender Victoria. I have attached a copy of my resume and my Key Selection Criteria responses. My unique combination of lived and professional experience hopefully distinguishes me as an exceptional candidate for this opportunity.

Over six years ago (six years, 6 months and 17 days ago to be precise!), I was given a shot at a Senior Project Management role at your organisation. Kathi and Andrew interviewed me—despite my complete lack of experience in community services. I am still very grateful for that opportunity because it helped me move forwards in terms of my desire to move away from the soulless world of banking and finance.

Fast-forward to now, and I am proud to say that I have completed a Diploma of Community Services and I now have over four years of community services experience.

As a queer, non-binary, neurodivergent person of colour, my lived experience navigating my own gender identity, and the challenges and triumphs that come whilst navigating this journey, has given me a deep understanding of how hard it can be to seek services and support. The challenges for me personally include discrimination and exclusion for each of my intersections, which include family violence, homelessness, mental ill-health and psychosocial disability. This lived experience has instilled in me a profound commitment to empowering and advocating for marginalised communities.

My four years in community services and a decade in the finance sector enable me to be adept in roles requiring strong interpersonal skills and building rapport with people from all walks of life. I have a proven ability to provide strengths based, person-led, empathetic support. By virtue of my own identity journey and also via the volunteer work I've done at Thorne Harbour Health, I have an understanding of services and resources available to the TGD community and have a demonstrated ability to connect individuals to essential resources. As a Peer Support Group Facilitator at Thorne Harbour Health, I honed my skills in active listening, creating a safe and inclusive space, and I firmly believe I would excel in this role.

Transgender Victoria's commitment to social justice and inclusivity aligns with my passion for advocacy and empowering my community. My lived experience, my professional background, and my dedication to social justice would make me a valuable asset to your team.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Nishant Dougall